



GLOBAL RHYTHMS
ETHAN SPERRY, EDITOR



R A M K A L I

AN INDIAN RAGA



ARRANGED BY
ETHAN SPERRY

T T B B

for Srinivas Krishnan

Ramkali

Freely, Unmeasured

(take lots of time between each phrase)

An Indian Raga
arr. Ethan Sperry

p overtone singing

T1

R

p

T2

Ah

p modulate vowels

B1

aeiou

p modulate vowels

B2

aeiou

7

Ah

modulate vowels

overtone singing

Ah

modulate vowels

Ah

aeiou

14

overtone singing

R

modulate vowels

Ah

Ah

21

left half of choir
p cresc.
Te re ke te Da, Te re ke te Da, Te re ke te Da!

right half of choir
p cresc.
Da din din da Da din din da Da din din da Da din din da

24

Te re ke te Da, Te re ke te Da, Te re ke te Da!

Da din din da Da din din da

26

f
Te te Ka ta guh Di ge na Da! Te te Ka ta guh Di ge na Da! Te te Ka ta guh Di ge na

f
Te te Ka ta guh Di ge na Da! Te te Ka ta guh Di ge na Da! Te te Ka ta guh Di ge na

28

Da! Te te Ka ta guh Di ge na da - Ha!

Da din din da Da din din da Te te Ka ta guh Di ge na da - Ha!

30

Guh di ge na da - Ha! Guh di ge na Da din din da da din din da

Guh di ge na da - Ha! Guh di ge na Da!

Hoon tho

32

**In Tempo**

1st time: moderate; 2nd time: fast

ga - dng ga - dng ga - dng ga - dng ga - dng ga - dng

Dng ga dng ga dng ga dng ga dng ga dng ga

Ah

va - ri va - ri ja - woon thu-muh-re gu - sai-yan, Hoon tho va - ri va - ri ja-woon

35

ga-dng ga-dng ga dng Hoon tho va - ri va - ri ja-woon

dng ga dng ga dng ga dng dng ga dng ga dng

dng dng dng dng dng dng dng dng ga-duh-kuh ga-duh-kuh

thu-muh-re gu - sai - - - - yan. dng ga - dng ga -

38

thu-muh-re gu - sai - yan, Hoon tho va - ri va - ri ja-woon thu-muh-re gu - sai -

ga dng ga dng ga dng ga dng ga dng ga dng

ga-duh-kuh ga-duh-kuh ga-duhkuh ga-duhkuh ga-duh-kuh ga-duh-kuh

dng ga - dng ga - dng ga-dng ga - dng ga - dng ga -

41

- yan. tuhkuh-dng tuhkuh-dng t k dng (= tuh-kuh-dng) t k dng

ga dng ga dng Duh kuh ga duh kuh ga duh kuh ga duh kuh ga

ga-duh-kuh ga-duh-kuh Huh, Huh, Huh, Huh,

dng ga-dng ga - Huh - muh - ri bath ka - chu maan - pya - re, Hoon tho

44

Huh-muh-ri bath— ka-chu maan - pya - re, Hoon tho va - ri, va - ri, _____

duh kuh ga duh kuh ga duh kuh ga duh kuh ga dng - k, dng - k, duh - k

Huh, Huh, Huh, Huh, Huh, Huh, dng - k, dng - k, duh - k

va - ri, va - ri, t k dng t k dng Thu-muh-re mi - la - nuh ki,

47

Ah—

dng - k, dng - k, duh - k dng - k, dng - k, duh - k dng - k, dng - k, duh - k

dng - k, dng - k, duh - k dng - k, dng - k, duh - k dng - k, dng - k, duh - k

ah-suh pi - ya re, Thu-muh-re mi - la - nuh ki, ah-suh pi - ya re,

50

Ah—

dng - k, dng - k, t k t k dng - k, dng - k, t k t k dng - k, dng - k, t k t k

dng - k, dng - k, t k t k dng - k, dng - k, t k t k dng - k, dng - k, t k t k

Cha-yan na pa - rat ma - re pya - - - re— Chayan na pa - rat ma - re

53

Thu-muh - re mi - la - nuh ki,

dng - k, dng - k, t k t k dng - k, dng - k, t k t k Ta - ki - ta, Ta - ki - tuh, Ta - kuh

dng - k, dng - k, t k t k dng - k, dng - k, t k t k Ta - ki - ta, Ta - ki - tuh, Ta - kuh

pya - re Hoon tho va - ri va - ri Dng ga dng ga

56

ah-suh pi - ya re, Thu-muh - re mi - la - nuh ki, ah-suh pi - ya re,

Ta - ki - ta, Ta - ki - tuh, Ta - kuh Ta - ki - ta, Ta - ki - tuh, Ta - kuh Ta - ki - ta, Ta - ki - ta, t k t k

Ta - ki - ta, Ta - ki - tuh, Ta - kuh Ta - ki - ta, Ta - ki - tuh, Ta - kuh Ta - ki - ta, Ta - ki - ta, t k t k

dng ga dng ga dng ga dng ga dng ga dng ga dng ga

59

Cha-yan na pa - rat ma - re pya - - - re Cha-yan na pa - rat ma - re

Da Da Da Da Da Da Da Da Da

Da Da Da Da Da Da Da Da Da

Dng d g dng, Dng d g dng, dng dng Dng d g dng, Dng d g dng, dng dng Dng d g dng, Dng d g dng, dng dng

62

pya - re Hoon tho va - ri va - ri ga dng — ga dng

Da Da Da Da Da Da, Hoon tho va - ri va - ri ja-woon

Da Da Da Da Da Da, Hoon tho va - ri va - ri ja-woon

Dng d g dng, Dng d g dng, dng dng Dng d g dng, Dng d g dng, d g d g Dng ga dng ga

65

ga dng — ga dng ga dng — ga dng ga dng — ga dng —

thu-muh - re gu - sai-yan, Hoon tho va - ri va - ri ja-woon thu-muh - re gu - sai-yan, Hoon tho

thu-muh - re gu - sai-yan, Hoon tho va - ri va - ri ja-woon thu-muh - re gu - sai-yan, Hoon tho

Dng ga dng ga Dng ga dng ga Dng ga dng ga

68

— d g dng — d g dng — d g dng — d g dng — d g dng — d g dng —

va - ri, va - ri, Ah, Ah, Hoon tho va - ri, va - ri, Ah ya

va - ri, va - ri, Ah, Ah, Hoon tho va - ri, va - ri,

Dng d g dng d g dng d g dng d g dng d g dng d g

71

— d g dng — d g dng — d g Duh g dng, — d g Duh g dng, —
 ya ya ya ya ya ya, Hoon tho va - ri, va - ri,
 Ah ya ya ya ya ya, Hoon tho va - ri, va - ri, Ah, —
 dng d g dng d g Duh g dng d g Duh g dng d g

73

— d g Duh g dng, — d g Duh g dng, — d g Duh g dng, — d g Duh g dng, —
 Ah, — Ah, — Hoon tho va - ri, va - ri, va - ri, va - ri,
 Ah, — Hoon tho va - ri, va - ri, va - ri, va - ri,
 Duh g dng, d g Duh g dng, d g Duh g dng, d g Duh g dng, d g

High notes second time only.

75

— d g Duh g dng, — d g Duh g dng, — Dng d g d g Dng d g d g Dng Dng —
 va - ri, va - ri, va - ri, Hoon tho va - ri, va - ri, ja - woon
 va - ri, va - ri, va - ri, Hoon tho va - ri, va - ri, ja - woon
 Duh g dng, d g Duh g dng, d g Duh g d g dng, Duh g d g dng, Dng Dng —

77

Dng d g d g Dng d g d g Dng Dng Dng d g d g Dng d g d g Dng Dng Dng d g d g Dng d g d g Hoon tho
 thu-muh - re gu - sai-yan, Hoon tho va - ri yeah, Hoon tho va - ri yeah, Hoon tho
 thu-muh - re gu - sai-yan, Hoon tho va - ri yeah, Hoon tho va - ri yeah, Hoon tho
 Duh g d g dng, Duh g d g dng, Dng Dng Duh g d g dng, Duh g d g dng, Dng Dng Duh g d g dng, Duh g d g dng, Hoon tho

80

va - - - ri! Ta-ka di-mi Ta-ka ju-na
 va - - - ri! Ta-ka di-mi Ta-ka ju-na
 va - - - ri! Ka Ta-ka ju-na
 va - - - ri! Ka Ta-ka ju-na

right half of choir
left half of choir

FINE

83

Ta-ka di-mi Ta-ka ju-na Ta-ka di-mi Ta-ka ju-na Ju-na
 Ta-ka di-mi Ta-ka ju-na Ta-ka di-mi Ta-ka ju-na Ju-na
 Ka Ta-ka ju-na Ju-na Ta-ka di-mi Ta-ka ju-na
 Ka Ta-ka ju-na Ju-na Ta-ka di-mi Ta-ka ju-na

85

Ta-ka di-mi Ta-ka ju-na Ta - ka Ta-ka ju-na Ta dit Ta-ka ju-na Ta-ka Dom!

Ta-ka di-mi Ta-ka ju-na Ta - ka Ta-ka ju-na Ta dit Ta-ka ju-na Ta-ka Dom!

Ju-na Ta - ka Ta-ka ju-na Ta dit Ta-ka ju-na Ta-ka Dom!

Ju-na Ta - ka Ta-ka ju-na Ta dit Ta-ka ju-na Ta-ka Dom!

88

Ta dit Ta - ka ju - na Ta - ka Dom! Ta-di-Gi-na dom, Ta-di-Gi-na dom, Ta-di-Gi-na dom,

Ta dit Ta - ka ju - na Ta - ka Dom! Ta-di-Gi-na dom, Ta-di-Gi-na dom, Ta-di-Gi-na dom,

90

D.S. al FINE

Ta-di-Gi-nadom, Ta-di-Gi-nadom, Ta-di-Gi-na dom, Ta!

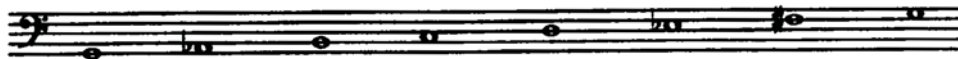
Ta-di-Gi-nadom, Ta-di-Gi-nadom, Ta-di-Gi-na dom, Ta!

Ta-di-Gi-nadom, Ta-di-Gi-nadom, Ta-di-Gi-na dom, Ta-di-Gi-nadom, Ta-di-Gi-nadom, Ta-di-Gi-na dom, Ta!

Ta-di-Gi-nadom, Ta-di-Gi-nadom, Ta-di-Gi-na dom, Ta-di-Gi-nadom, Ta-di-Gi-nadom, Ta-di-Gi-na dom, Hoon tho

India has a rich and deep musical tradition dating back thousands of years. Like the West, India has a large and structured set of music schools and conservatories where students are trained to be virtuoso musicians beginning at a very early age. But unlike Western schooling which is based on learning to read and interpret written sheet music, Indian musical instruction is based almost exclusively on aural tradition and improvisation. Most Indian ensembles consist of one or two percussionists to provide the rhythm and one or two melodic instrumentalists (violin, flute, sitar...) or vocalists to provide the melody which is superimposed over a *shruti* box which drones the root and fifth of the scale for the duration of the piece. Indian music is based on the melody creating and resolving dissonance with this drone rather than on functional harmony. The melodic players or singers either perform in unison or alternate, often imitating each other—they rarely create harmony or polyphony. This arrangement attempts to reproduce these traditional Indian sounds using only the human voice. The drone is replicated through a combination of lower voices singing held syllables while upper voices use harmonic overtone singing. A variety of nonsense syllables are used to effectively mimic the sound of Indian percussion instruments.

The term “raga” generally refers to the specific scale upon which a piece of Indian music is based. There are well over 400 specific ragas which have been defined and named in the classical Indian tradition. Some are seven notes ascending and the same seven notes descending like Western scales, but others contain more or fewer notes with a variety of chromaticisms, and others have different patterns when the melody ascends or descends. In most cases, a raga consists of an improvised introductory section or *allap* which is slow and introduces the notes of the scale often without rhythmic accompaniment. This is usually followed by a faster section which is also improvised based upon the notes of the raga. Some ragas have specific melodies which are associated with them, while others are usually open for freer forms of improvisation.



RAMKALI is considered one of the most complex ragas to sing as it is perfectly symmetrical (unlike either the major or minor scale) and contains many of the notes that are most dissonant against the drone. The *allap* section of this raga introduces the notes of the scale along with grace notes that highlight bent pitches off the scale. The faster *tintal* section uses a melody with a quasi-religious text which has been associated with the Ramkali scale for several centuries. This arrangement asks the choir to speak what might be “percussion solos” during the raga using SOLLAKATTU or RHYTHMIC SOLFEGE. Western music uses nonsense syllables (Do, Re, Mi) to teach pitch and intervals; Indian music uses syllables to teach rhythmic patterns. This tradition dates back for centuries, but recently performers have been using these syllables in performance instead of just as a pedagogical tool. It is common to hear percussionists speak a rhythm in syllables and then play the same rhythm on the drum as an echo. As many Indian drums such as the tabla and mridangam are capable of producing high and low pitches, sollakattu syllables are often inflected with high and low pitches instead of droned monotonically.

A prose translation of the text is as follows:

Hoon tho vari vari jawoon thumuhre gus
Huhmuhri bath kachu maan pyare
Thumuhre milanuh ki ahsuh pyare
Chayan na parat mare pyare

I am entirely devoted to you my lord.
At least heed my plea, my love.
I hope to be united with you, my love.
Peace of mind is not mine, my love.

A literal translation and a pronunciation CD are available from the Publisher



Born in 1971 in New York City, **Ethan Sperry** began studying conducting at the age of eight, cello at the age of twelve, and singing at the age of eighteen. He has earned a bachelor's degree in Philosophy from Harvard College and Masters and Doctoral degrees in Choral Conducting from the University of Southern California. Ensembles under his direction have toured to Bermuda, Estonia, Finland, France, Germany, Guadeloupe, Italy, Jamaica, Japan, Korea, Luxembourg, Puerto Rico, Russia, and Taiwan, and have performed at major venues in the United States including The Hollywood Bowl, The Kennedy Center, Washington D.C.'s National Cathedral, St. Patrick's Cathedral in New York City, The Nassau Coliseum, Cincinnati's Music Hall, and Boston's Symphony Hall. Currently Sperry is Associate Professor of Music at Miami University in Ohio, where he conducts the Men's Glee Club, Collegiate Chorale, and Global Rhythms Ensembles and teaches classes in vocal and choral music and The Music of Russia. He is also the artistic administrator of the Arad Philharmonic Chorus in

Arad, Romania, and from 2001-2003 was the principal conductor of the Choeur Regional de Guadeloupe, the only symphonic choir in the French West Indies. An enthusiastic cook, Sperry has won awards for his baking and his recipes have been printed in Bon Appetit magazine and the Cincinnati Enquirer.